

A Slice of Global Finance



Over the past 10 years, the Narendra Modi government has been able to push through some key reforms in the financial sector. Chief among them are the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, the Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana on financial inclusion and, of course, the Unified Payments Interface (UPI). As the government nears the end of its second term, one of the biggest moves it is currently engaged in—believed to be a pet project of Prime Minister Modi—is to bring global finance into India in a major way in the form of the Gujarat International Finance Tec-City, or GIFT City, the international financial services centre (IFSC) near Ahmedabad. GIFT City is now in the process of getting a major fillip as the government eases regulations, creates infrastructure and ensures ease of doing business to ensure global and Indian financial firms set up operations there. The buzz around GIFT City was in ample evidence at the recent Vibrant Gujarat Global Summit, where the PM and Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman underscored the seriousness of the government's intent to ensure the IFSC becomes a major player in the frenetic world of global finance.

GIFT IFSC currently houses 580 operational entities, including three exchanges, 25 banks (including foreign ones), 29 insurance entities, two foreign universities, 26 aircraft lessors, 40 fintech firms and over 50 professional services providers. It has over \$52 billion in total banking assets and about \$25 billion in committed investments from 80 funds. And this is only the beginning. With around 400 offices and 26,000 people already working there, GIFT IFSC is on its way to becoming a serious player on the lines of Singapore and Dubai and turning into a reinsurance, aircraft- and ship-leasing hub.

Surabhi brings you the ground report from GIFT City in our cover story, pointing out that it is “primed for action”. A key move making it attractive for global players is the regulatory dispensation allowing for ease of international finance, particularly with the setting up of the International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA), the regulator. “We would want them [foreign investors] to come into a jurisdiction where they feel at ease in terms of ease of doing business, the quality of the regulations, the clarity of the regulations, tax certainty and so on,” says IFSCA Chairperson K. Rajaraman. A move to allow direct listing of firms in GIFT City is expected to boost activity further.

Elsewhere, we bring you a curtain-raiser on the Interim Budget 2024 to be presented by the Finance Minister. While she has made it clear that there would be no spectacular announcements, there are expectations that it may give a push to rural households and provide some tax relief to individuals. The Interim Budget will need to continue on the fiscal consolidation path, but it's an election year after all. **BT**

Sourav Majumdar

sourav.majumdar@ajtak.com
@TheSouravM

Business Today

<http://www.businesstoday.in>

Chairman & Editor-in-Chief: Aroon Purie
Vice Chairperson & Executive Editor-in-Chief: Kalli Purie
Group Chief Executive Officer: Dinesh Bhatia
Executive Director: Rahul Kanwal
Chief Operating Officer: Alok Nair
Editor: Sourav Majumdar
Group Creative Editor: Nilanjan Das
Group Photo Editor: Bandeep Singh

Managing Editor, Business Today TV: Siddharth Zarabi

Managing Editor: Anand Adhikari
Executive Editor: Krishna Gopalan

Executive Editor, Businesstoday.in: Arvin Vincent
Senior Editor, Businesstoday.in: Mukesh Adhikary

CORRESPONDENTS

Economy Editor: Surabhi
Senior Editors: Neetu Chandra Sharma, Nidhi Singal
Editor (Money Today): Teena Jain Kaushal
Senior Associate Editor: Ashish Rukhaiyar
Associate Editor (Money Today): Navneet Dubey
Senior Assistant Editor: Binu Paul
Assistant Editors: Arnab Dutta, Prerna Lidhoo, Vidya S.

RESEARCH

Assistant Editor: Rahul Oberoi
Principal Research Analyst: Prince Tyagi

COPY DESK

Senior Editor: Abhik Sen
Senior Assistant Editors: Shishir Kumar Behera, Vikram Gopal
Senior Sub Editor: Pranay Prakash

PHOTOGRAPHY

Principal Photographer: Rajwant Singh Rawat
Staff Photographer: Hardik Chhabra
Senior Photo Researcher: Vishal Ghavri

ART

Creative Editor: Anirban Ghosh
Deputy Art Director: Rahul Sharma
Associate Art Director: Raj Verma
Chief Designer: Prabal Biswas

EVENTS

Senior Manager: Sourabh Dutta

PRODUCTION

Chief of Production: Harish Aggarwal
Senior Production Coordinator: Narendra Singh
Production Coordinator: Ayekpam David Meitei

LIBRARY

Assistant Librarian: Satbir Singh

BUSINESS TEAM (MAGAZINE)

National Head-Business Today Magazine: Siddhartha Chatterjee
Assistant General Manager: Girish C

BUSINESS TEAM (BT TV)

National Head-BT TV: Masuma Parekh
SGM & Branch Head-North & East: Abhinav Gupta

AD OPS

Deputy General Manager: Avinash Karkera
Marketing: Vivek Malhotra, Group Chief Marketing Officer
Newsstand Sales: Deepak Bhatt, Senior General Manager
(National Sales); Vipin Bagga, General Manager (Operations);
Rajeev Gandhi, Deputy General Manager (North),
Yogesh Godhanlal Gautam, Deputy Regional Sales Manager (West),
S. Paramasivam, Deputy Regional Sales Manager (South)

**Vol. 33, No. 3, for the fortnight January 22, 2024
to February 4, 2024. Released on January 22, 2024.**

● Editorial Office: India Today Mediaplex, FC 8, Sector 16/A, Film City, Noida-201301;
Tel: 0120-4807100; Fax: 0120-4807150 ● Advertising Office (Gurgaon): A1-A2, Enkay Centre, Ground
Floor, V.N. Commercial Complex, Udyog Vihar, Phase 5, Gurgaon-122001;
Tel: 0124-4948400; Fax: 0124-4030919; Mumbai: 1201, 12th Floor, Tower 2, One World Center
(Jupiter Mills), S.B. Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai-400013; Tel: 022-69193355;
Fax: 022-66063228; Chennai: 5th Floor, Main Building No. 443, Guna Complex, Anna Salai,
Teynampet, Chennai-600018; Tel: 044-28478525; Fax: 044-24361942; Bangalore: 202-204 Richmond
Towers, 2nd Floor, 12, Richmond Road, Bangalore-560025; Tel: 080-22212448;
080-30374106; Fax: 080-22218335; Kolkata: 52, J.L. Road, 4th floor, Kolkata-700071;
Tel: 033-22825388; 033-22827726; 033-22821922; Fax: 033-22827254; Hyderabad: 6-3-885/7/B,
Raj Bhawan Road, Somajiguda, Hyderabad-500082; Tel: 040-23401657; 040-23400479;
Ahmedabad: 2nd Floor, 2C, Surya Rath Building, Behind White House, Panchwati,
Off: C.G. Road, Ahmedabad-380006; Tel: 079-65603933; 079-6560929; Fax: 079-65652933; Kochi:
Karakatt Road, Kochi-682016; Tel: 0484-2377057; 0484-2377058; Fax: 0484-370962
● Subscriptions: For assistance contact Customer Care India Today Group, C-9, Sector-10,
Noida (UP) - 201301.
Email: wecare@intoday.com | Phone / Whatsapp: +91 8597 778 778 (Monday to Friday, 10 am-6 pm)

● Sales: General Manager Sales, Living Media India Ltd., C-9, Sector 10, Noida (UP) - 201301;
Tel: 0120-4019500; Fax: 0120-4019664 © 1998 Living Media India Ltd.

All rights reserved throughout the world. Reproduction in any manner is prohibited.

● Printed & published by Manoj Sharma on behalf of Living Media India Limited.
Printed at Thomson Press India Limited, 18-35, Milestone, Delhi-Mathura Road, Faridabad-121007,
(Haryana). Published at F-26, First Floor, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110001.

Editor: Sourav Majumdar

● Business Today does not take responsibility for returning unsolicited publication material.

All disputes are subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of competent courts and forums in Delhi/
New Delhi only.



For reprint rights and syndication enquiries, contact
syndications@intoday.com or call +91-120-4078000

www.syndicationtoday.in